

Value Added Tax (VAT)

 ura.go.ug/en/vat-registered-category

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VAT is an indirect tax on consumption charged on value added to taxable supplies at different stages in the chain of distribution. In Uganda, VAT is imposed on the supply of goods and services (taxable supplies) made by a taxable person, other than exempt supplies; and imports other than exempt imports.

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Who is a VAT registered taxpayer?

This is a taxpayer with a business that makes total sales above Ugx 150,000,000 in a given year and deals in taxable supplies.

If you run any business in this category and are not yet registered, you're advised to register for VAT.

[Click here](#) to register for VAT

What are examples of businesses in this category?

These could include supermarkets, hardware outlets, general merchandise shops, distributors and agents, electronics and electrical appliances, provided they qualify in turnover.

What are my obligations as a VAT registered taxpayer?

- Register for EFRIS
- Charge and collect VAT on taxable supplies by issuing an e-invoice
- File a VAT return within 15 days after the end of the month

- Maintain proper business records
- Avoid making false, reckless and misleading statements
- Pay VAT due as assessed in the return within 15 days after the end of the month

The filing and payment due date for VAT all fall in the same date.

What are the benefits of VAT registration?

- You're in position to supply established institutions and/or government which leads to more profits and business growth
- You avoid inconveniences arising from unfair assessments

Am I supposed to register for EFRIS?

Yes. You must register for EFRIS if you operate a business in this category Section 73 A (2).

[Click here](#) for information on how to register for EFRIS

How do I file returns for my business?

You are required to file returns if you operate a business in this category

[Click here](#) for information on how to file your returns.

How do I pay taxes to URA?

After filing a return, you're required to pay the resultant tax using any of the available payment platforms e.g. banks, mobile money, EFT, RTGS, VISA, Mastercard, USSD code (*285#) etc.

Please note: the due date for payment of tax is the same as that of return filing.

[Click here](#) to register a payment

When do I qualify for a refund?

You qualify for a refund if your input VAT (VAT on purchases) exceeds your output VAT (VAT on sales) by more than Ugx 5,000,000. And when your input VAT is supported by e-invoices.

How do I apply for refunds?

This can be done as you are filing your VAT monthly return, by selecting cash refund, if your input VAT exceeds your output VAT by Ugx 5,000,000 and above.